KINAN MARTIN

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SUMMARY

Applied AI engineer with a research background in NLP, speech processing, and robotics. Experienced in rapidly scoping, developing, and deploying end-to-end solutions in diverse technical domains — from training and deploying VLA models on robotic embodiments, to building full-stack applications, to releasing open-source ASR models. Thrives in ambiguous, high-stakes environments that demand fast iteration and cross-functional problem-solving.

EXPERIENCE

Applied AI Engineer — **June 2024 – present**
Reazon Holdings — *Tokyo, Japan*

- Trained multiple Vision-Language-Action models incl. pi0.5 for deployment on the OpenArm bimanual robotic embodiment; wrote custom controller runtime to bridge model inference with real-time hardware control
- Developed a custom temporal aggregation method inspired by ACT to smooth action chunk boundaries, increasing model inference rate by 400% and improving model fluidity and reactivity
- Built a Next.js frontend to demo trained VLA models at NVIDIA GTC 2026
- Released ReazonSpeech-k2-v2, an open-source Japanese ASR model that outperforms OpenAI's Whisper large-v3 with over 10x fewer parameters
- Designed and led development of full-stack React app for real-time bilingual transcription & annotation; increased out-of-domain word accuracy by 21% and optimized LLM prompt structure to reduce latency by 80%
- Drove team adoption of AI-assisted development tools (Claude Code, Gemini CLI), establishing best practices that increased team development velocity

Artificial Intelligence Research Intern — **June 2023 – August 2023**
Foxconn — *Taipei, Taiwan*

- Spearheaded project using multimodal vision-language models, computer vision models, and LLMs for a smart driving assistant
- Designed and implemented novel model architecture and dataset generation pipeline
- Jointly submitted US and Taiwanese patents for the above

Student Researcher — **May 2022 – May 2024**
Massachusetts Institute of Technology — *Cambridge, MA*

- Completed master's thesis on the relationship between contextual predictability and phonetic reduction; designed novel probing paradigm for self-supervised spoken language models
- Published first-author paper accepted to int'l spoken language processing conference INTERSPEECH 2023
- Taught 600+ students as TA for 6.101 Fundamentals of Programming; led weekly staff meetings for 30+ lab assistants
- Co-authored paper on Spanish clinical word embeddings published in *Frontiers* and paper published by *ACL* (2nd place in SMM4H 2022 shared task) through MIT international research program at University of Chile

EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology — **September 2019 – May 2024**
Master of Engineering in Computer Science and Cognition — GPA: 4.8 / 5.0
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Cognition — GPA: 4.9 / 5.0

SKILLS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

Foreign Languages	Japanese, French, Russian, Chinese, Arabic, Spanish; learning Korean, Vietnamese, Polish, and more
Coding Languages	Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML/CSS, *nix/Bash, SQL, MATLAB, R, LaTeX
Software & Tools	Git, GitHub Actions (CI/CD), React.js, Next.js, AWS, GCP, Vercel, Supabase, Hugging Face, PyTorch, Tensorflow, wandb, Pandas, slurm, ROS 2, Claude Code, Gemini CLI

- Passed the highest level of the international Japanese Language Proficiency Test (JLPT N1) in the 96th percentile (2017).
- 1st place in Russian Poetry Recitation, 2nd place in Speech Contest at New England Olympiada of Spoken Russian at Harvard University (2020).